4.3 Fresh Water

Rain water is considered to be the purest form of water, as it contains very less proportion of salts when compared to the oceans and seas. Hence it is called fresh water. A major part of fresh water is found in the frozen state in the form of ice caps and glaciers. Around 1% of it is found in the liquid state as rivers, streams, lakes, ponds etc. Surface water may also penetrate through porous rocks and gets collected beneath the Earth's surface. This is called groundwater.

Fact

Finland is known as the land of thousand lakes. There are 1,87,888 lakes in Finland.

Water table is a level below the ground, where water is found collected beneath the Earth's surface.

Aquifers are porous rock strata filled with water, found below the earth's surface.

4.4 Oceans

The continents and oceans are however, not evenly distributed in the northern and the southern hemispheres. The northern hemisphere holds 61% of land whereas the southern hemisphere holds 81% of water. It is because of this pattern of land and water distribution, the **northern hemisphere** is called as the **land hemisphere** and the **southern hemisphere** is called as the **water hemisphere.**



Hots

- **71% of the earth is covered by water, but very little can be used by humans. Why?**
- **The oceans are salty. Why?**

Oceans and seas are considered as resource bowl of the earth because of the immense availability of food, minerals etc., Present distribution of the world's oceans and major seas are illustrated in the map.

Sylvia Earle is a famous American oceanographer . She was named as the first, 'Hero for the Planet' by Time magazine for her efforts towards marine life protections.

Jacques-Yves Cousteau (1910-1997) was a famous French Ocean explorer, who conducted extensive under-sea investigations .

He belonged to the information service of the French Navy, and was sent on missions to Shanghai and Japan (1935–1938) and in the USSR (1939).

Honours

- **Cross of War 1939–1945 (1945)**
- **U.S. Presidential Medal of Freedom (1985)**

4.4.1 Relief Of The Ocean Floor

The ocean basins are **characterised by the following major relief features:**

BY296M

(A) Continental shelf
(B) Continental slope
(C) Continental rise
(D) Deep sea plain or Abyssal plain
(E) Oceanic deep
(F) Oceanic ridge

(A) Continental Shelf

A shallow and gently sloping platform extending out from the adjoining continental land mass into the sea is called Continental Shelf. It is almost a uniform zone of sea bed with a gentle gradient.

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